CHAPTER 7

PATHS TO MODERNISATION

CHAPTER ESSENCE AT A GLANCE:
Master contrasting East Asian modernisations: Japan's Meiji Restoration industrial statecraft (Fukoku Kyohei) and zaibatsu capitalism versus China's revolutionary path from the 1911 Revolution, CCP triumph, Great Leap Forward, to Deng Xiaoping's Four Modernisations.

4 CORE PRINCIPLES TO UNDERSTAND FIRST

• **Contrasting Geographies and Modernisation Models:** Japan responded to Western threat through state-directed top-down capitalist modernisation (Meiji Restoration 1868); China experienced violent revolutionary transformations under foreign imperialist subjugation.

• **Meiji Japan: Fukoku Kyohei and Zaibatsu:** Slogan 'Rich Country, Strong Army' drove modernization: universal education, telegraph and rail infrastructure, modern banking, and family-owned financial-industrial conglomerates (Zaibatsu: Mitsui, Mitsubishi).

• **Chinese Revolutionary Waves:** Sun Yat-sen's 1911 Revolution established the Republic based on Three Principles (Nationalism, Democracy, People's Livelihood); Chiang Kai-shek's Guomindang failed to address agrarian inequality.

• **Maoist Revolution and Deng Reforms:** Mao Zedong led the CCP to victory in 1949 with peasant backing; launched the Great Leap Forward (1958) and Cultural Revolution; Deng Xiaoping transformed China from 1978 with the Socialist Market Economy and Four Modernisations.

ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL CHRONOLOGIES & THEMES

Meiji Modernisation Mantra $\Longleftrightarrow$ Fukoku Kyohei $\rightarrow$ Rich Country, Strong Army

State-Directed Industrial and Military Modernization

Sun Yat-sen Three Principles $\Longleftrightarrow$ San Min Chu-i $\rightarrow$ Nationalism + Democracy + Socialism/Livelihood

Foundational Ideology of the 1911 Chinese Republic

Maoist Communist Transformation $\Longleftrightarrow$ Long March (1934–35) $\rightarrow$ Peasant Mobilisation $\rightarrow$ 1949 People's Republic

Agrarian Revolutionary Trajectory to Power

Deng Xiaoping 1978 Pragmatism $\Longleftrightarrow$ Four Modernisations + Socialist Market Economy + SEZs

Post-Mao Economic Open-Door Transformation Paradigm

CRUCIAL EXAM PRECAUTIONS & VALUATION RUBRIC SECRETS

• **Alert:** Japan was never colonized by Western imperialist powers; China was reduced to a semi-colony through unequal treaties following the Opium Wars.

• **Alert:** In Japan, Zaibatsu were powerful private business empires (Mitsubishi, Sumitomo) that worked in close synergy with the Meiji government.

• **Alert:** Sun Yat-sen's 'Three Principles' (San Min Chu-i) must be cited accurately: Nationalism (expelling foreign imperialists), Democracy (constitutional governance), and Livelihood (agrarian land reform).

HIGH-YIELD CENTUM QUESTIONS & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS

1. Explain the major reforms introduced in Japan after the Meiji Restoration of 1868. [Score: 4 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **1. Slogan 'Fukoku Kyohei':** Adopted the national mission of 'Rich Country, Strong Army' to defend sovereign independence against Western imperialist domination. **[1 Mark]**

• **2. Universal Compulsory Education:** Introduced mandatory modern schooling for all boys and girls studying Western science while inculcating loyalty to the Emperor. **[1 Mark]**

• **3. Economic and Industrial Modernization:** State established modern silk and textile mills, built telegraphs, postal systems, and railways, then sold state factories cheaply to Zaibatsu business families. **[1 Mark]**

• **4. Military Conscription:** Replaced the traditional samurai caste with a modern citizen army based on universal military conscription. **[1 Mark]**

2. What were the 'Three Principles of the People' (San Min Chu-i) propounded by Dr. Sun Yat-sen? [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **1. Nationalism (Minzu):** Overthrowing the foreign Manchu Qing dynasty and freeing China from Western imperialist exploitation. **[1 Mark]**

• **2. Democracy (Minquan):** Establishing a constitutional democratic republic with representative government. **[1 Mark]**

• **3. Livelihood (Minsheng):** Regulating capital, equalizing land ownership, and ensuring economic security for impoverished peasants. **[1 Mark]**

3. Analyze the factors responsible for the triumph of the Chinese Communist Party (CCP) under Mao Zedong in 1949. [Score: 4 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **1. Mobilization of the Peasantry:** Mao recognized poor peasants as the vanguard of revolution, winning their loyalty through radical agrarian land distribution in Jiangxi and Yan'an. **[1.5 Marks]**

• **2. Discipline and the Long March (1934-35):** The historic 6,000-mile military retreat created disciplined guerrilla fighters and heroic mythologies. **[1 Mark]**

• **3. Corruption of Guomindang:** Chiang Kai-shek's regime alienated the masses through rampant inflation, warlord alliances, and brutal suppression of protests. **[1.5 Marks]**

4. Explain the economic reforms initiated by Deng Xiaoping in China in 1978. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **The Four Modernisations:** Targeted modernization of Agriculture, Industry, Science and Technology, and National Defence. **[1 Mark]**

• **Socialist Market Economy:** Dismantled agricultural communes under the Household Responsibility System, permitting private profit incentives. **[1 Mark]**

• **Open Door Policy and SEZs:** Established Special Economic Zones (Shenzhen) offering tax incentives to attract massive foreign direct investment and export manufacturing. **[1 Mark]**

5. What were the Zaibatsu in Japan? Give two examples. [Score: 2 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Definition:** Immense, family-owned financial, commercial, and industrial conglomerates that dominated the modern Japanese economy from the Meiji era to World War II. **[1 Mark]**

• **Examples:** Mitsubishi and Mitsui (or Sumitomo and Yasuda). **[1 Mark]**

6. What was the May Fourth Movement of 1919 in China? [Score: 2 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Significance:** A massive intellectual and student protest in Beijing against the Versailles Peace Treaty giving German concessions in Shandong to Japan; launched the New Culture Movement promoting science, democracy, and vernacular literature. **[2 Marks]**